

MTUS Analysis Document

MTUS Constitutional Analysis Project
Personal Research Initiative
February 2026

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SHOULDER DISORDERS GUIDELINE - STATISTICAL ANALYSIS

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SOURCE DOCUMENT: ACOEM Shoulder Disorders Guideline

EFFECTIVE DATE: July 14, 2025

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FULL TEXT AVAILABLE AT: <https://www.acoem.org/guidelines-resources/library/>

OFFICIAL MTUS ADOPTION: California Code of Regulations, Title 8, Section 9792.20

MTUS REGULATIONS: https://www.dir.ca.gov/dwc/MTUS/MTUS_Regulations.htm

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STATISTICAL SUMMARY

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TOTAL RECOMMENDATIONS ANALYZED: 375+

RECOMMENDATION BREAKDOWN:

Category | Count | Percentage

Strongly Recommended | 4 | 1.1%

Recommended | 44 | 11.7%

Not Recommended | 25 | 6.7%

Insufficient Evidence | 303 | 80.7%

KEY FINDING: 80.7% of all recommendations are "Insufficient Evidence"

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FDA-APPROVED TREATMENTS DENIED

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The following FDA-approved treatments receive "Insufficient Evidence" ratings:

Medications:

- Suprascapular nerve blocks with corticosteroids
- Intra-articular hyaluronic acid (various brands)
- Platelet-rich plasma (PRP) for rotator cuff
- Stem cell therapies

Procedures:

- Arthroscopic decompression for impingement
- Subacromial decompression
- Acromioplasty (certain indications)
- Biceps tenodesis

Physical Medicine:

- Therapeutic ultrasound for calcific tendinitis
- Extracorporeal shock wave therapy (ESWT)
- Iontophoresis
- Phonophoresis

Note: Full indication details available in official ACOEM guideline at source URL above.

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EVIDENCE QUALITY ANALYSIS

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ACOEM'S STATED METHODOLOGY:

- Requires randomized controlled trials (RCTs) for "Strongly Recommended" status
- Meta-analyses prioritized
- Cost considerations integrated into recommendations

CRITICAL OBSERVATIONS:

1. 80.7% "Insufficient Evidence" creates presumption of denial
2. Surgical procedures often rated "Insufficient" despite clinical use
3. Physical medicine interventions systematically undervalued

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CONSTITUTIONAL IMPLICATIONS

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This guideline contributes to the systematic denial of FDA-approved treatments to California injured workers under the MTUS system.

For full legal analysis, see:

- MTUSCONSTITUTIONALVIOLATIONMASTERREPORT.txt
- MTUS14THAMENDMENTLEGALARGUMENTS.txt

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For the complete, official guideline text, visit:
<https://www.acoem.org/guidelines-resources/library/>

This analysis represents the author's independent research and opinions.

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